Alpha Basket Assistant

Operating guide and performance, v1.04, 14 October 2026

One sentence: the EA shows you the trade, you click once, it manages the rest.

It never opens a trade by itself. Entries need your click. Stops, break-even, OCO cancel, time exits and loss guards are automatic.

START HERE: one-time setup (5 minutes)

1. Open **ACG Markets MT5**. Open a **USDJPY.pro** chart, timeframe M5.

2. Navigator (Ctrl+N) > Expert Advisors > drag **AlphaBasketAssistant** onto the chart.

3. In the dialog, Common tab: tick **Allow Algo Trading**. Inputs tab: **InpAccountStart = 10000**, **InpTargetPct = 10** (use 5 in phase 2). Leave everything else. Click OK.

4. Toolbar: the **Algo Trading** button must be green.

5. Look at the **health light** at the top right of the panel. Green **ALL SYSTEMS OK** = good. Red = fix the thing it names before anything else.

The health light

It says	Meaning	What to do
ALL SYSTEMS OK (green)	clock, time zone and AutoTrading are fine	nothing
AUTOTRADING OFF (red)	the Algo Trading button is off	click it until it is green
CHECK TIME ZONE (red)	the PC time zone is wrong	Windows Settings > Time: set the time zone automatically, restart MT5
CHECK PC CLOCK (red)	the PC clock is minutes off, or no price feed	Windows Settings > Time > Sync now, restart MT5

Keep MT5 running on this PC (or a VPS) from 05:00 to 11:30 IST every weekday and 16:30 to 17:30 IST on month-end days.

Before the live challenge: email AlphaBasketAssistant.ex5 to ACG support for approval (template on the last page).

READING THE PANEL (30 seconds)

Card	What it tells you	Good looks like
Title bar	UTC time, server offset, the health light	green ALL SYSTEMS OK
ACCOUNT	balance, equity, progress bar to the phase target	bar filling to the right
TODAY'S SAFETY	daily loss used (bar), max loss used (bar), the loss if every stop hit, protect mode	short bars, nothing red
VOL FILTER	ON or OFF for today, ATR20 against its 250-day median	ON = box and gotobi trade today; OFF = both skip, that is the rule
BOX BREAKOUT	status word, box levels, stop and target in pips, lots, trades today	READY at 06:00 IST, then WORKING, IN TRADE or DONE
GOTOBI SHORT	status word, next date, entry and close times, stop and lots	TODAY in the morning, SIGNAL at 06:25 IST
MONTH-END BID	same for the M-3 trade	TODAY on the 3rd-last weekday, SIGNAL at 16:30 IST
OPEN BASKET POSITIONS	each open trade with entry, stop, R and P/L	
Two button rows	top = box (place / skip), bottom = gotobi or M-3 (place / skip)	green = click once; red = blocked, reason on the button; grey = nothing to do

Status words on the leg cards

Word	Meaning
WAITING / NOT TODAY	nothing to do; the card shows the next date or time
TODAY	this leg trades today; be at the screen at its time
READY / SIGNAL / RE-ENTRY	click the green button now
WORKING	stop orders are in the market, waiting for price
IN TRADE / OPEN	a position is open; the EA manages it
DONE	finished for today (take profit, two trades, expired, or closed)
SKIPPED / VOL OFF / MISSED	no trade today: by rule, by you, or the 10-minute window passed

HOW AND WHEN TO PLACE: step by step

Before every click, three checks: health light green, the button names the right leg with sane lots, nothing red in TODAY'S SAFETY.

BOX BREAKOUT, 06:00 IST every weekday

1. 05:59 be on the chart. The BOX card says WAITING and the box levels are forming.

2. 06:00 the card turns **READY** and the top button turns green: *PLACE BOX STOP ORDERS 0.43 lots $25 risk until 05:30*. The lots change with the box size; the risk is always about 0.25% of balance.

3. Click it **once**. The card turns **WORKING**: a buy stop at the box high and a sell stop at the box low, both expiring 11:00 IST.

4. Do nothing. When one side fills the other is cancelled (IN TRADE). At +3R the stop moves to just above entry. The target is 9R. The trade may run overnight.

5. If the trade is stopped out before 11:00 IST, six minutes later the button may say **PLACE RE-ENTRY STOP**: one stop on the other side of the box. Click or skip. Two trades a day maximum.

6. Late? Within 10 minutes of 06:00 the click still works (it goes to market if price has already left the box). After that the EA refuses if the box has broken, and the day is simply closed.

GOTOBI SHORT, 06:25 IST on the 5th, 10th, 15th, 20th, 25th and last day of the month (weekend dates move to Friday)

1. In the morning the GOTOBI card says **TODAY** with the lots and the stop in pips. If it says VOL OFF, there is no trade today.

2. 06:25 the bottom button turns green: *SELL GOTOBI NOW 2.09 lots $360 risk until 01:05*. The risk is about 3.6% of balance.

3. Click it **once**. The card shows **OPEN**; the stop is 0.25 x ATR20 above the entry; no target.

4. Do nothing. The EA closes it at **11:30 IST** whatever the P/L. If the stop hits first, that is the trade.

5. Late? The button stays green until 06:35. After that the card says MISSED: do not chase it.

MONTH-END BID (M-3), 16:30 IST on the 3rd-last weekday of the month

1. The card says **TODAY** from the morning. Vol filter does not matter for this one.

2. 16:30 the bottom button turns green: *BUY M-3 NOW 2.09 lots $360 risk*.

3. Click it **once**. Stop 0.25 x ATR20 below the entry, no target. The EA closes it at **17:30 IST**.

If the button is red, read the reason on it and use page 4. Never place these trades by hand instead: the sizing and the guards would be gone.

WHEN SOMETHING HAPPENS

Red button reasons

Button says	What it means	What to do
daily guard: x% used of 4%	today's loss incl. open trades reached 4% of the day-start balance	no more entries today; let open trades run to their stops
daily budget: x% at the stops > 4.6%	if every stop hit, today's loss would pass 4.6%	wait: once a box trade reaches break-even the budget frees up
max-loss guard / max-loss budget	the account is within 1% of the 10% limit	stop trading the challenge; talk before continuing
lot below the minimum	stop too wide for 0.01 lots at this risk	skip; nothing to fix
AutoTrading is off	Algo Trading button is red	click the toolbar button, then click PLACE again
PC clock disagrees...	Windows clock is off or the price feed is dead	sync the clock, restart MT5
margin x needed, y free	not enough free margin	skip this trade

Things NOT to do

1. Do **not** switch Algo Trading off while a basket trade or order is open: the OCO cancel, break-even and time exits stop with it.

2. Do **not** widen a stop by hand. Tightening is fine; the EA respects a tighter stop.

3. Do **not** run two copies of the EA (two charts). One chart, one EA.

4. Do **not** change inputs mid-day. Change them after 11:30 IST when nothing is open.

5. Do **not** trade other things on this account during the challenge: every open trade counts against the same 5% day.

If MT5 was closed or crashed

Start it again and the EA rebuilds its state from the trade history: open trades keep their management, today's trade count is recounted, old orders past their expiry are deleted. A pending order that filled while MT5 was off is adopted and managed from the first tick.

Where to look: Toolbox > Experts tab shows every action with a time stamp. The file MQL5\Files\ABA_log.csv in the terminal data folder has the same lines plus requested-versus-filled prices (use it to check slippage after 20 trades).

THE RULES AND THE ODDS

Rules the EA follows (all fixed in the backtest)

Leg	Entry	Stop	Exit	Risk
Box breakout	06:00 IST: buy stop at the 05:00-05:59 high, sell stop at the low, one fills and the other is cancelled	box size + spread	take profit 9R; at +3R the stop moves to entry + box/6; overnight allowed	0.25%
Gotobi short	06:25 IST sell at market on 5/10/15/20/25/month-end (weekend dates move to Friday)	0.25 x ATR20	11:30 IST	3.6%
Month-end bid (M-3)	16:30 IST buy at market on the 3rd-last weekday of the month	0.25 x ATR20	17:30 IST	3.6%

Box and gotobi only trade when ATR20 is at or above its 250-day median (the VOL FILTER card). M-3 trades every month.

Guards (the EA enforces them before you can click)

Guard	Limit	Firm's limit
Daily loss including open trades, from the balance at 00:00 server time	entries blocked at 4%	5% = account closed
Entry budget: loss if every stop hits, plus costs	4.6% of the day-start balance	
Total loss from the account start	entries blocked at 9%	10% = account closed
Protect mode	all risk halved while balance is below 97% of the start	
Lot cap	5 lots per order	

Challenge odds (backtest, challenge starts 2018-2025, firm rules with open trades counted, budget modelled)

Mix: box / gotobi / M-3	Pass within 60 days	Lose account within 60 days	Pass eventually	Months per funded account
0.25 / 3.6 / 3.6 (EA default)	24.5%	9.9%	67%	7.8
0.25 / 4 / 4	25.5%	14.3%	58%	7.9
0.25 / 3 / 3	20.0%	7.4%	79%	7.9

Median time to pass is about 80 days. One attempt in three to four never passes. No sizing turns this basket into a 50% two-month pass; that would need an edge nobody has found in 10 research cycles.

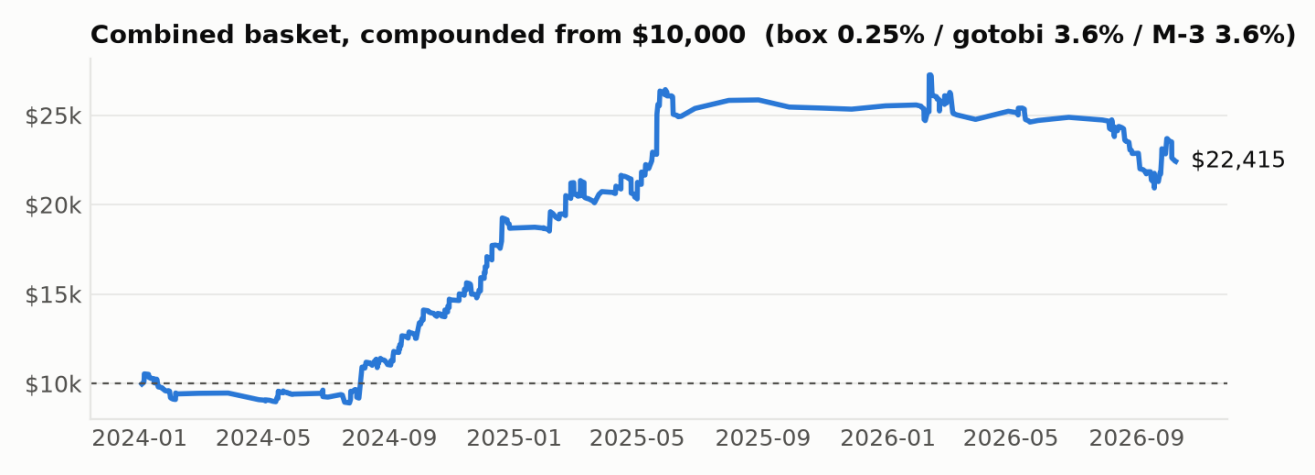
PERFORMANCE 2024 TO 2026

Backtest on Dukascopy minute data with all costs, the EA's exact rules and risk (box 0.25%, gotobi 3.6%, M-3 3.6%). Percent of a fixed balance, trades grouped by exit month. Data to 8 October 2026.

Year	Box	Gotobi	M-3	Combined	Trades
2024	+9.9%	+58.3%	-1.4%	+66.8%	233
2025	+3.3%	+25.7%	+3.7%	+32.6%	118
2026 to 8 Oct	+5.0%	-16.9%	+0.3%	-11.6%	113
Total	+18.2%	+67.1%	+2.6%	+87.8%	464

Leg	Trades	Win rate	Avg R	Best month	Worst month
Box (0.25%)	344	25%	+0.21	+6.0%	-3.2%
Gotobi (3.6%)	87	54%	+0.21	+20.6%	-11.2%
M-3 (3.6%)	33	61%	+0.02	+3.3%	-3.9%
Combined	464			+25.2%	-8.2%

Compounded, all three legs from $10,000: **$22,415** on 8 October 2026, worst peak-to-trough drawdown **23%**. That drawdown is why the challenge odds are one in four, not certain: a 10% loss ends the account.



Read with care

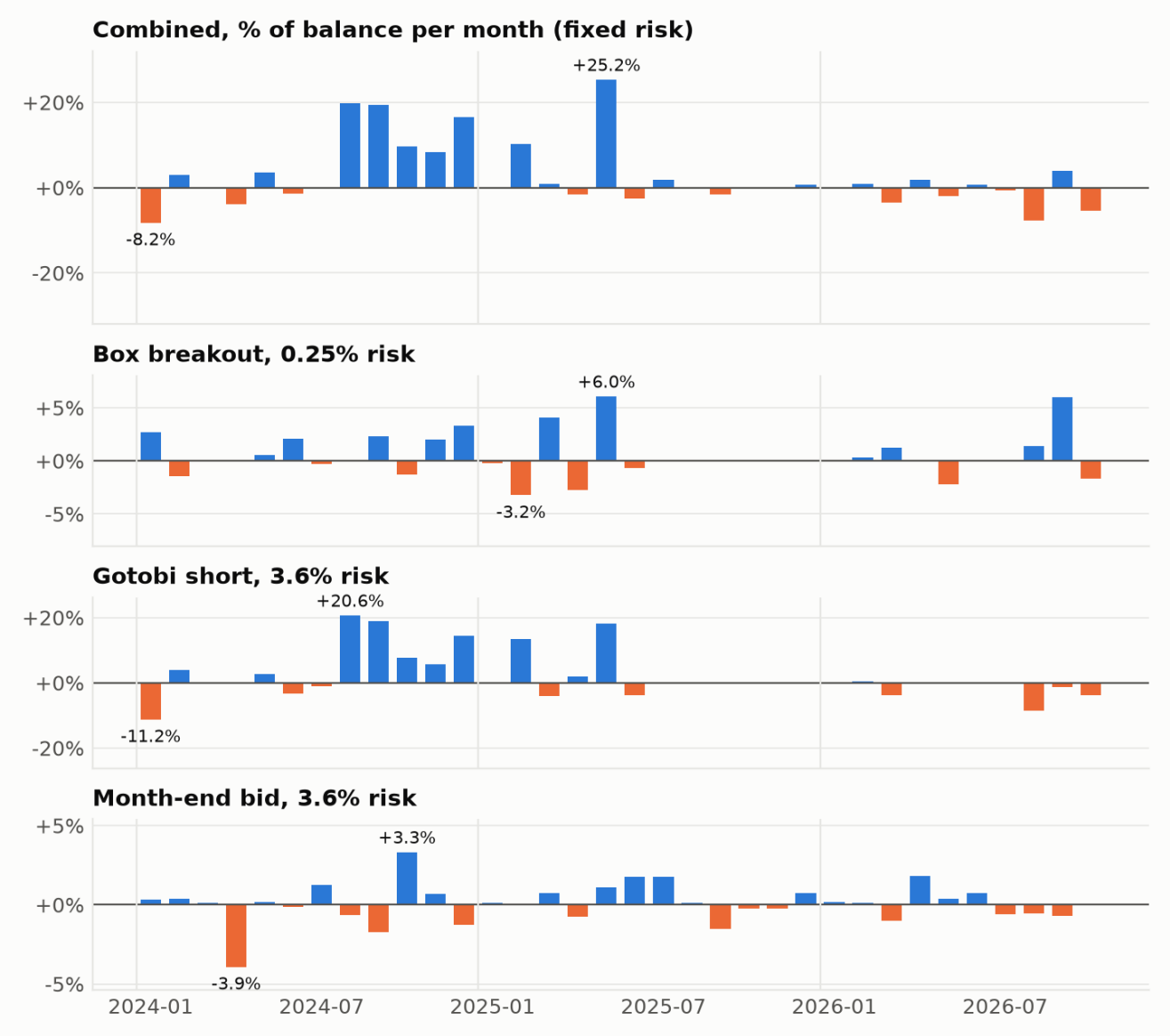
1. The box rules were chosen on 2024-2026 data (gj-strat, STRATEGY.md), so the box's 2024-2026 numbers are flattered. Gotobi and M-3 were found on 2010-2023 and 2024-2026 is unseen for them.

2. The vol filter switched OFF from July 2025 to January 2026 and in several other months: only M-3 traded then. Long quiet stretches are normal.

3. 2026 is the first losing year of the three: the gotobi gave back 17% at 3.6% risk. Three years is a short record for a strategy with 87 gotobi trades.

MONTH BY MONTH

Blue = positive month, orange = negative month. Each panel is one leg; the top panel is all three together. Labels mark each panel's best and worst month.



MONTHLY TABLE 2024 TO 2026 (percent of a fixed balance)

Month	Box	Gotobi	M-3	Combined	Trades
2024-01	+2.70%	-11.21%	+0.31%	-8.20%	29
2024-02	-1.43%	+3.99%	+0.37%	+2.93%	8
2024-03	+0.00%	+0.00%	+0.15%	+0.15%	1
2024-04	+0.00%	+0.00%	-3.91%	-3.91%	1
2024-05	+0.56%	+2.72%	+0.18%	+3.47%	26
2024-06	+2.09%	-3.38%	-0.14%	-1.43%	7
2024-07	-0.28%	-1.05%	+1.26%	-0.06%	21
2024-08	-0.06%	+20.56%	-0.64%	+19.85%	30
2024-09	+2.29%	+18.82%	-1.73%	+19.38%	34
2024-10	-1.26%	+7.63%	+3.30%	+9.67%	29
2024-11	+1.97%	+5.75%	+0.69%	+8.41%	20
2024-12	+3.31%	+14.49%	-1.25%	+16.55%	27
2025-01	-0.24%	+0.00%	+0.12%	-0.13%	4
2025-02	-3.23%	+13.41%	+0.06%	+10.24%	24
2025-03	+4.11%	-4.01%	+0.75%	+0.85%	19
2025-04	-2.74%	+1.91%	-0.73%	-1.56%	22
2025-05	+6.03%	+18.10%	+1.11%	+25.24%	35
2025-06	-0.66%	-3.72%	+1.75%	-2.63%	8
2025-07	+0.00%	+0.00%	+1.77%	+1.77%	1
2025-08	+0.00%	+0.00%	+0.10%	+0.10%	1
2025-09	+0.00%	+0.00%	-1.54%	-1.54%	1
2025-10	+0.00%	+0.00%	-0.23%	-0.23%	1
2025-11	+0.00%	+0.00%	-0.23%	-0.23%	1
2025-12	+0.00%	+0.00%	+0.73%	+0.73%	1
2026-01	+0.00%	+0.00%	+0.19%	+0.19%	1
2026-02	+0.34%	+0.53%	+0.11%	+0.98%	28
2026-03	+1.21%	-3.77%	-1.00%	-3.55%	8
2026-04	+0.00%	+0.00%	+1.84%	+1.84%	1
2026-05	-2.20%	-0.19%	+0.36%	-2.04%	13
2026-06	+0.00%	+0.00%	+0.72%	+0.72%	1
2026-07	+0.00%	+0.00%	-0.60%	-0.60%	1
2026-08	+1.38%	-8.51%	-0.55%	-7.68%	26
2026-09	+5.96%	-1.24%	-0.71%	+4.01%	26
2026-10	-1.70%	-3.76%	+0.00%	-5.46%	8

0.00% with 0 trades = the vol filter was OFF (box, gotobi) or the trade fell in another month. M-3 has one trade a month by construction.

ACG APPROVAL AND FILES

Why approval is needed

ACG's help centre allows EAs on MT5 only for risk management and trade assistance, each pre-approved by email. EAs that open trades without human oversight are refused. This EA only places orders after your click, so it fits the allowed category, but it still needs the email.

Email template

Subject: EA pre-approval request, account 2574088, AlphaBasketAssistant.ex5

Hello,

Please pre-approve the attached Expert Advisor (AlphaBasketAssistant.ex5) for my account 2574088.

It is a trade-assistance and risk-management tool for USDJPY: it displays a dashboard, calculates lot sizes from a fixed risk percent, and places orders only after I click a button on the chart (no unattended entries). It manages my stop-loss and take-profit, moves the stop to break-even, cancels the opposite pending order when one side fills, closes timed trades, and blocks new entries when my daily or maximum loss limits are approached. It does not trade on news, does not copy trades and is used by me alone.

Thank you,
[your name]

Files

What	Where
Compiled EA (attach this to the email)	C:\Users\Helld\AppData\Roaming\MetaQuotes\Terminal\1CF428C3FDF926B70F50CBA0C390D9FD\MQL5\Experts\AlphaBasketAssistant.ex5
Source code	D:\Traders sir\mt5\AlphaBasketAssistant.mq5
Setup guide (text)	D:\Traders sir\mt5\README.md
Trade log written by the EA	...\1CF428C3FDF926B70F50CBA0C390D9FD\MQL5\Files\ABA_log.csv
Monthly results (CSV)	D:\Traders sir\runs\basket\monthly_2024_2026.csv
Sizing study	D:\Traders sir\runs\basket\speed_report.md

Three questions to ask ACG support at the same time

1. Is the daily loss measured from the balance at 00:00 server time, or from the higher of balance and equity? (The EA uses the balance.)

2. What is the commission per lot on USDJPY.pro? (The EA assumes $7 round turn in its budget.)

3. Is the account leverage 1:30 or 1:100? (The terminal showed 1:100 margin on 14 October 2026.)

Next action: tomorrow 06:00 IST, click the green box button once.